Q1 Methodology, Limitations & References

Research Governance, Verification Framework & Data Boundaries

1. Research Methodology & Verification Hierarchy

This project enforces an **Evidence-First Rule**, governing all source selection through a 4-Tier Source Hierarchy:

- **Tier 1 (Primary / Official Government Statistics):** MoSPI HCES 2023–24 datasets providing official macroeconomic baselines.
- **Tier 2 (Institutional Trade & Syndicated Surveys):** USDA FAS Retail Foods Annual (IN2025-0055), NIQ Global Health 2025, Ipsos Essentials 2023, PwC.
- **Tier 3 (Corporate Disclosures & Filings):** Tata Consumer Products Annual Reports, ITC Stock Exchange Releases, Z47 & L Catterton venture filings.
- **Tier 4 (Commercial Market Publishers):** IMARC, MRFR, Data Bridge (Subjected to definition and discrepancy audits).

Every claim is processed through an analytical chain:

\text{Fact} \longrightarrow \text{Finding} \longrightarrow \text{Insight} \longrightarrow \text{Business Implication}

2. Data Boundaries & Research Limitations

1. **Absence of Longitudinal Trackers:** No single, nationally representative 5-year continuous tracking survey specifically dedicated to urban healthy food consumption exists in the public domain.
2. **Sample Frame Differences:** Consumer survey statistics (NIQ, Ipsos) represent directional snapshot signals across differing sample frames (e.g., urban netizens vs. active grocery buyers) and cannot be merged into a calculated multi-year trend line.
3. **Publisher Definition Opacity:** Commercial market research publishers vary widely in category scope (mixing fortified staples with organic items), resulting in non-comparable market size estimates.

3. Mandatory Future Validation Requirements

Before committing capital to business entry, the following primary validation steps are required:

- City-level retail price elasticity testing for target product formats.
- Consumer trial-and-repeat panel tracking across quick-commerce platforms.
- In-person store audits across modern trade and specialty wellness channels.

4. Bibliographic References

1. **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), GoI.** (2025).

Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2023–24: Key Results.
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3. **NielsenIQ (NIQ).** (2025). *Global State of Health & Wellness Study 2025*.
4. **Ipsos.** (2023). *Essentials Wave: Consumer Health & Wellbeing Priorities in India*.
5. **PwC India.** (2024). *Voice of the Consumer Survey: India Perspective*.
6. **Tata Consumer Products Limited.** (2026). *Integrated Annual Report 2025–26*.
7. **ITC Limited.** (2023). *Corporate Disclosure: Acquisition of Sproutlife Foods Private Limited*.